

Proofreading: Training Guide

Training Goals: The audience will understand that:

- Proofreading is the essential last check to find and remove typing errors before printing.
- It is very important to read the translation out loud to check for errors.
- Proofreaders need a checklist for their own language standards. This will guide them to read a translation printout several times, looking for a different kind of error each time.
- Translation leaders can contact their Wycliffe Associates contact person to access, translate, and customize a *Proofreading Checklist* for their language.

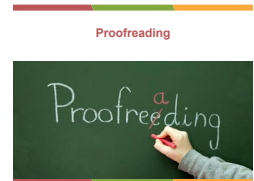
Estimated Time: 30-45 minutes

Materials: ✓ Slides: *Proofreading - Slides (Optional)*
✓ **Proofreading Exercise** (1 copy for each person)
✓ White board and markers (Optional)

Note to Trainers in Gateway Languages (GLs): The Exercise CANNOT be translated directly. Prepare the Exercise according to its preparation instructions below. If the GL uses different rules than English does, edit the checklist to match the rules for the GL. Also, change the examples used in the checklist demonstration. Use rules and examples that are appropriate for the language being used.

Introduction: This session is about **proofreading**. As you know, **checking is done during the 4 checking steps of the translation process, but the translation still needs further review and quality checks.**

If the group is planning to print through Wycliffe Associates, understand that **proofreading is an essential step for them.**



Ask: What are some other checking and review processes we have already talked about?

**Quality Assessment Guide,* *Reviewers' Guide,*
Spiritual Terms Evaluation*

These quality reviews are done to make sure that the text **clearly** and **consistently** communicates the **message** of Scripture.

Proofreading is done to make sure that things like punctuation and formatting are correct throughout the text, and to find any last errors that are still present.

- Most errors found during proofreading are not present because of incorrect translation. The main translation will already be checked many times before proofreading! Instead, the errors found by proofreaders are **usually small typing (or typographical) errors**.
- It is far easier to see these last errors and to correct them when looking at a **printout** of the translation, instead of looking only at a computer screen.
- Small typographical errors **can affect the message** indirectly. Consider these examples:



• Proofreading finds mostly typing errors.
• These errors may affect meaning.

Use examples to demonstrate that **even the smallest typed symbols can have a major impact on meaning**. Use the following examples in English, or different examples in the Gateway or Target Language.

For each example, show the slide or write the sentence on the board.

Example 1: Call me Pat.

Read the sentence aloud.

Ask: What does this sentence mean?

Explain: This means I want to be called by the name "Pat."

Call me Pat.
Call me, Pat.
I'm sorry I love you.
I'm sorry. I love you.

Proofreading

Example 2: Add a comma after “me”: **Call me, Pat.**

- 🗣️ **Ask:** Does anyone know how the comma changes the meaning in English?
- 🗣️ **Explain:** Now it means that I am asking a person named Pat to call me.

Example 3: I’m sorry I love you.

- 🗣️ **Read** the sentence aloud without a pause.
- 🗣️ **Ask:** What does this mean?
- 🗣️ **Explain:** To a native English speaker, this sounds like I regret loving another person.

Example 4: Add a period after “sorry”: **I’m sorry. I love you.**

- 🗣️ **Ask:** Does anyone know how the period changes the English meaning?
- 🗣️ **Explain:** Now this sounds like I am apologizing to a person I love.

These are just two examples in English where punctuation affects meaning. Just as voice inflection and facial expression can change the meaning of what is said aloud, in many languages small differences like this can change the meaning of what is written.

- 🗣️ **Ask:** Are there any examples in your language where punctuation, an accent mark, one different letter, or another small change in writing or printing could change the meaning of the words?

Correct punctuation, capitalization, accent marks, spelling, and formatting are all important to clearly communicate what the Scripture says. Because these kinds of errors **often happen during typing**, and because they **look especially obvious in print**, corrections need to be done in this **last stage before Bibles are printed and distributed**. When a language community creates a finished translation that avoids these types of errors, others see that it has been done well and carefully.



22But the fruit OF the spirit is love joy) peace, patience, Kindness, goodnesss, Faith, gentleness, adn selfcontrol against such things there is no law . 24 those who belong to christ Jesus have cRucified the flesh with its passionsa nd desires²⁵ If we live by teh Spirit, let us also walk” by thespirit?

From Galatians 5:
22But the fruit OF the spirit is love joy) peace, patience, Kindness, goodness, Faith, gentleness, and self-control against such things there is no law . 24 those who belong to christ Jesus have cRucified the flesh with its passionsa nd desires²⁵ If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk” by thespirit?

²² But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, ²³ gentleness, and self-control; against such things there is no law. ²⁴ Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. ²⁵ If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit.

Show slide or another example of text with typing and formatting errors, followed by the correct text.

- 🗣️ **Ask:** What do you notice about these two examples?

- **Would one of these examples be easier to read?**
- **If you received a printed Bible with the first example of text, would you have a different opinion of its quality than if you received it with the second example? Why or why not?**

Give people time to point out errors.

Explain: Proofreading is an opportunity to find and correct typing errors in the text, as well as verse numbers in the Scripture. Each language has its own set of rules for punctuation and capitalization. Some languages may not have a fully developed set of rules yet. **The translators will need to decide what rules and format they will follow.** The proofreader will make sure that the translation consistently follows the system they agreed on.

Proofreading

-  **Ask:** Does your language have a set of rules for beginning and ending sentences? Does your language have rules about how to show that someone in the text is speaking? Does your language use capital and lowercase letters?

These are some of the things a proofreader should notice and mark in the text, if they are incorrect.

Explain: Before proofreading, print a ***Proofreading**

Checklist* for each proofreader to use. Below are some examples of categories to put on a checklist, based on English-language proofreading. Your language might have different or additional things to list. **Contact your Wycliffe Associates contact person to access the *Proofreading Checklist,* and to modify and translate it for your language.**

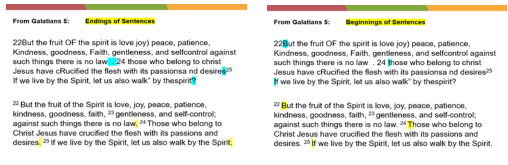
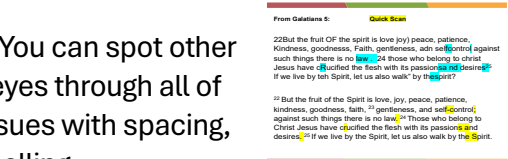
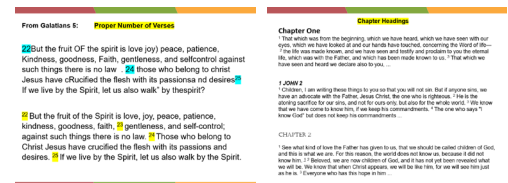
Notice that the checklist requires the proofreader to **read or scan the chapter several times, looking for different types of errors each time.** Some read-throughs will focus on the **type of error** that should be found. Other read-throughs will practice a **specific method of checking**, which will help the proofreader to notice different types of errors.

If the team made a grammar chart when they began translating, explain that they can use their chart to help them create a proofreading checklist for their language.

Demonstrate the list quickly with slides or other examples. Each slide shows the passages above with errors highlighted. **If the last four items do not apply to the audience's language, substitute those items for rules and examples that do apply to the language.**

- **Proper number of verses:** Check that each verse is present and marked with the correct number. The checklist will include how many verses are in each chapter.
- **Chapter heading:** Check that the chapter number is correct, and that its format and spacing are the same as for other chapters.
- **Quick scan:** Do a quick scan of all the spacing and all the text. You can spot other mistakes and small errors just by taking a minute to scan your eyes through all of the chapter text rapidly. This quick scan can help you to spot issues with spacing, accent marks, numbers, punctuation, capitalization, or even spelling.
- **Read aloud:** Read through the text aloud at least once, checking more slowly and carefully for typing errors. When you hear the text at the same time as you look at it, you will find more errors. This is a very important thing to do.
Note: This is the step where you are most likely to notice spelling errors. Proofreaders should correct spelling errors of common words. **However, they should check with the translation team for decisions on difficult word choices, or if the same word seems to be misspelled many times.**

- **Endings of sentences:** Check that each one has end punctuation appropriate for the sentence type.
- **Beginnings of sentences:** Check that each one starts with a capital letter.



Proofreading

- **Pairs, such as quotation marks, parentheses, or brackets:**

Each one has a partner. (Exception: in some languages, long quotations with multiple paragraphs have opening quotes at the beginning of each paragraph, but only one set of final quotes at the end.)

- Capitalization:** Check that names of people and places begin with a capital letter.

Choosing Proofreaders: The translation team will choose one or more proofreaders to proofread the entire New Testament. **Proofreading requires a different kind of “looking” than other types of review.** This process will get faster once proofreaders gain experience.

Find one or more individuals within the translation team who care about details in printed material and notice them. Choose proofreaders who notice such things easily and who enjoy this kind of work.

Remember that each proofreader will need a ***Proofreading Checklist.***

The Proofreading Process:

- Proofreaders should look at **one chapter at a time**.
- They should use the *Proofreading Checklist* to focus on **one category or checking method at a time**. Proofreading will not be as effective if proofreaders try to find many things at the same time.
- Proofreaders will most easily find these last little errors if they look at the text **in print** and make sure to **read it out loud**. This is very important. Proofreaders can read the translation out loud to themselves or to partners. (Partners may also listen and watch for errors as they read.)
- When proofreaders find anything that should be fixed in the chapter, they should **mark it or write it down**. Proofreaders should talk with their typists beforehand to agree on markings or notes that the typist will easily understand.
- When a category has been checked throughout the chapter, proofreaders should mark the corresponding Checklist box to show that this category is completed.
- If proofreaders notice **something other than what is on the Checklist, they should write a note for the whole translation team**. The team will make decisions on such changes.

Making Corrections: A typist will need to make the corrections that the proofreaders found. Once proofreaders have completed their review of a whole book, the team typist must enter the necessary changes in BTT Writer. Then the corrections can be saved, and the text can be uploaded to WACS.

Exercise: Proofread a Chapter Using a Prepared Checklist

Preparation *Important*: This Exercise must be prepared ahead of time if training is not in English. Do not simply translate the exercise from English. It will not work. Instead, type or paste Mark 16 from the source language ULB into a document. Then insert deliberate, simple errors for trainees to find, such as errors in punctuation, spacing, spelling, or formatting. If needed, edit or add to the proofreading categories in the checklist to match the rules of the language.

From John 8:	Question Marks	From Galatians 5:	Question Marks
17 Then Jesus said to the twelve, "You do not want to go away alone, do you? Have I not said to you already that if you believe in Me, you will never die?" 18 "For whom would we go?" They were wanting to answer him. 19 And they who have believed know as he knows that they are the Holy City of God!		22But the fruit of the Spirit is love joy peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, gentleness, and self-control against such things there is no law . 24 Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires! If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit?	
22 As Paul James presbiter a tax doer; 23 Tarsilian satelles symon pharisee; 24 Sathana Simons pharisee; La quatin messias; 25 sathanes quoniam deus dei est Sancto de Christo;		22 But the hull of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, gentleness, and self-control against such things there is no law . 24 Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. 25 If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit.	
From John 8:	Paradoxes	From Galatians 5:	Paradoxes
1 After those things, Jesus went away to the other side of the Sea of Gallilee, called the Sea of Tiberias. A great number were following Him, because they saw the signs that He was doing on those who were sick . 1 Jesus came by the mountains and there sat down His twelve disciples . 1 Now the Passover, the Jewish festival, was at hand, and many Jews were come up to Jerusalem, coming from far, to hear of Philip, "where are we going to buy bread so that these may eat?" [But Jesus said this to test Philip, for He himself knew what He was going to do]		22But the Fruit of the Spirit is love joy peace, patience, kindness, goodness, Faith, gentleness, and selfcontrol again such things there is no law . 24 Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires! If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit?	
		22 But the hull of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, gentleness, and self-control against such things there is no law . 24 Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. 25 If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit.	

with a capital

not preachers

Proofreading: A Different Kind of "Looking"

- **One chapter at a time**
- **One category at a time**
- **Read out loud!**
- **Mark the corrections**
- **Correct spelling errors in common words**
- **Mark the Checklist box when each category is completed**

Chapter 5 26 verses

☐ verse numbers

☐ chapter number

☐ spacing

☐ read through aloud

☐ ends of sentences

☐ starts of sentences

☐ pairs: { } ~ []

☐ capital on names

☐

☐

Proofreading

Purposes: This Exercise has two purposes. **The first purpose is to reinforce the value of proofreading by letting everyone try it.** There can be many small errors in a text that looks good at first glance. Experiencing this will help the team understand how important proofreading is. Not everyone will be able to find many errors, and that is fine. Encourage everyone and affirm what they do find. **The second purpose of this Exercise is to find people with proofreading ability.** When a translation team works on the Exercise, leaders should **notice those who enjoy the Exercise and who find many errors.** Translation team leaders may want to choose these individuals to be proofreaders for their translation. The individuals who go on to proofread their translation will then have this experience to guide them.

Process: Trainees should follow the checklist given in the Exercise to search for errors in the Scripture passage provided. They should mark errors they find in the Exercise. Trainees should NOT use the ULB or any other text as a comparison. They should find errors using only the categories in the Exercise. Explain that they may be tempted to skip some steps, but they should NOT skip any steps. **Point out step 4, where trainees are instructed to read the text out loud.**

Note to those who are training in English: Reassure everyone that, if they are not native English speakers, some of these errors may be difficult to notice. Help them understand that anything they find is excellent, but the Exercise does not allow enough time for people to find every error. Ask everyone to think as they work about what kinds of errors they commonly see when their own language is written or printed. Remind them that when proofreaders are checking their translation, they will have a checklist that fits their own language.

Allow about fifteen minutes for the Exercise. **Once the time is done** for the exercise, have the participants share a few examples of the errors they found. Some trainers find it beneficial to go around the room and allow each person to share only one error they found. Pointing out a unique error for each person can help to relieve pressure and to affirm everyone's accomplishment.

An **Answer Key** for the trainer in English is included at the end of this walkthrough, and a list of explanations to help the trainer review. Trainees do not need to find all of the errors. The answers and explanations are for the trainer's information only, if needed for the discussion.

Ask:

- **How hard was this exercise? What did you struggle with?**
- **Did you find a lot of errors or just a few?**
- **Did it make a difference when you read it out loud?**
- **If the errors you found got fixed, would it make it easier for readers to understand the text?**

Let participants talk about what they found. Do not point out all of the errors. Use the discussion time to help them understand the importance of doing each step separately and carefully.

Confirm: The audience understands that:

- ☐ Proofreading is the essential last check to find and remove typing errors before printing.
- ☐ It is very important to read the translation out loud to check for errors.
- ☐ Proofreaders need a checklist for their own language standards. This will guide them to read a translation printout several times, looking for a different kind of error each time.
- ☐ Translation leaders can contact their Wycliffe Associates contact person to access, translate, and customize a *Proofreading Checklist* for their language.



Proofreading Exercise

Use the instructions below to find errors in the Scripture passage on the next page. Remember to:

- Read text out loud at least once.
- Mark errors as you find them. You may circle them or write a suggested correction.
- Where instructed, look for only one type of error at a time.
- When you complete each task, mark its box.

When you have finished, the group will review the exercise.

Important: If English is not your heart language, some English errors may be difficult to notice. As you work on this exercise, think about the kinds of errors you commonly see when your own language is written or printed.

- ☐ There should be 20 verses in this chapter. Count through to make sure all the verse markers are present. On the side of the page, write any numbers that are missing.
- ☐ Make sure the number for the chapter is at the beginning.
- ☐ Scan through the chapter text quickly to check for anything that looks odd (examples: uneven spaces between words, inconsistent sizes of numbers, words spelled incorrectly).
- ☐ **Read through the text out loud, watching for errors as you read.**
- ☐ Look specifically at the endings of sentences. Make sure each sentence has end punctuation (a period, a question mark, or an exclamation point, as appropriate).
- ☐ Look specifically at the beginnings of sentences to confirm that each one starts with a capital letter.
- ☐ Look specifically for pairs of marks, such as quotation marks, parentheses, and brackets. Does each one have a partner? Does what is inside pairs of quotes sound like it is what someone is saying?
- ☐ Make sure each name is capitalized. In English, this should be done for both people and places. This also includes all names for God (Lord, Father, Son, Jesus, Holy Spirit).

Proofreading Exercise

Mark 16

¹ When the Sabbath day was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices that they might come and anoint Jesus body. ² very early on the first day of the week, they went to the tomb when the sun had come up. They were saying to one another, 'Who will roll away the stone for us from the entrance to the tomb?' ⁴ When they looked up, they saw that the stone had been rolled away, for it was very large. ⁵ They entered the tomb and saw a young man dressed in a white robe, sitting on the right side, and they were alarmed.

⁶ He said to them, "Do not be alarmed. you seek Jesus, the nazarene, who was crucified. He is risen He is not here. Look at the place where they had laid him. ⁷ But go, tell his disciples and Peter, 'He is going ahead of you to galilee. There you will see him , just as he told you.'

⁸ they went out and ran from the tomb; they were trembling and amazed. They said nothing to anyone because they were so afraid. ⁹ [Early on the first day of the week, after he arose, he appeared first to Marymagdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons. ¹⁰ She went and and told those who were with him, while they were mourning and weeping¹¹ They heard that he was alive and that he had been seen By her, but they did not believe

¹² After these things he appeared in a different form to to of them as they were walking out into the country. They went back and told the rest, but they did not believe them.

¹⁴ Jesus later appeared to the eleven as they were reclining at the table ,and he rebuked them for their unbelief and Hardness of heart, because they did not believe those who saw him after he rose from the dead. ¹⁵ He said to them, 'go into all the world, and preach the gospel to the entire creation? ¹⁶ He who believes and is baptized will be saved, and he who does not believe will be condemned. ¹⁷ These signs will go with those who believe: In my name they will cast out demons. they will speak in new languages. They will pick up snakes with their hands, and if they drink anything deadly, it will not hurt them .They will lay hands on the sick, and they will get well"

¹⁹ After the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was taken up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of God. The disciples left and preached everywhere, while the Lord worked with them and confirmed the word by the signs that went with them

Mark 16 with errors highlighted

Mark 16

¹ When the Sabbath day was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices that they might come and anoint Jesus' body. ² Very early on the first day of the week, they went to the tomb when the sun had come up. They were saying to one another, Who will roll away the stone for us from the entrance to the tomb? ⁴ When they looked up, they saw that the stone had been rolled away, for it was very large. ⁵ They entered the tomb and saw a young man dressed in a white robe, sitting on the right side, and they were were alarmed. ⁶ He said to them, "Do not be alarmed. you seek Jesus, the nazarene, who was crucified. He is risen. He is not here. Look at the place where they had laid him. ⁷ But go, tell his disciples and Peter, 'He is going ahead of you to galilee. There you will see him, just as he told you.' ⁸ they went out and ran from the tomb; they were trembling and amazed. They said nothing to anyone because they were so afraid. ⁹ [Early on the first day of the week, after he arose, he appeared first to Marymagdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons. ¹⁰⁰ She went and and told those who were with him, while they were mourning and weeping. ¹¹ They heard that he was alive and that he had been seen. By her, but they did not believe.

¹² After these things he appeared in a different form to to of them as they were walking out into the country. They went back and told the rest, but they did not believe them.

¹⁴ Jesus later appeared to the eleven as they were reclining at the table, and he rebuked them for their unbelief and Hardness of heart, because they did not believe those who saw him after he rose from the dead. ¹⁵ He said to them, 'go into all the world, and preach the gospel to the entire creation? ¹⁶ He who believes and is baptized will be saved, and he who does not believe will be condemned. ¹⁷ These signs will go with those who believe: In my name they will cast out demons. they will speak in new languages. They will pick up snakes with their hands, and if they drink anything deadly, it will not hurt them. They will lay hands on the sick, and they will get get well."

¹⁹ After the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was taken up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of god. The disciples left and preached everywhere, while the lord worked with them and confirmed the word by the signs that went with them.

Further explanations of English exercise errors

Verse 1: space missing after comma, capital M needed on Mary, apostrophe needed on Jesus'

Verse 2: capital needed on Very

Verse 3: (starts at "They were saying...") double quotes needed before Who, question mark needed before double quotes after tomb

Verse 4: lowercase needed on away, less space should be after period

Verse 5: delete one "were"

Verse 6: capital needed on You and Nazarene, exclamation point needed after risen

Verse 7: verse marker should be small and raised like others, capital needed on Galilee, no space should be between him and comma, double quotes as well as single quote needed at end

Verse 8: capital needed on They after verse marker, no space should be between afraid and period

Verse 9: should be less space after verse marker, bracket has no partner, should be a space after Mary, should be capital on Magdalene

Verse 10: verse marker should be a 10 and small and raised like others, there is an extra "and" (end and beginning of line), should be a period and space at end

Verse 11: by should be lowercase, period should be at end

Verse 12: too much space above verse, should be "to two of them" not "to to of them"

Verse 13: verse marker is missing (starts at "They went back")

Verse 14: should be capital on Jesus, space should be after comma instead of before it, hardness should all be lowercase

Verse 15: double quotes should be before capital Go, space should be after comma, should be period instead of question mark

Verse 16: "hewho" needs a space to be "he who"

Verse 17: capital needed on They to begin last sentence

Verse 18: verse marker is missing (starts at "They will pick up"), in first sentence space should be after period instead of before it, "get" is repeated (end and beginning of line), and in second sentence a period should go before double quotes

Verse 19: should be Jesus instead of jeSus, capital needed on God

Verse 20: verse marker is missing (starts at "The disciples left"), capital needed on Lord, period should be at end of sentence